Pre-Market Fades

S&P −0.40% as morning's tech bid unwinds. AMD −5.39% into Tuesday's print. QCOM −4.88%. Bitcoin reclaims $80K, lifting the crypto sleeve.

THE SESSION

The pre-market tape did not survive the open. Friday closed at fresh all-time highs near 7,187 on the S&P 500, and the overnight read pointed to a tech-led continuation: XLK indicated +1.49%, CRDO bid +5.96%, AMD +1.71% into Tuesday's print. By the close, that sequencing had inverted. The S&P finished –0.40% at 7,201.32, the Dow shed –1.13% as cyclicals and industrials led lower, the Nasdaq cushioned at –0.19%, and the VIX advanced +7% to 18.18. Project Freedom commenced as scheduled, but Brent absorbed the convoy news without a meaningful reaction in either direction.

The day's defining move came inside the AI semiconductor complex. AMD closed –5.39% at $341.11 ahead of its Tuesday-after-close print, with HSBC issuing a downgrade Monday morning and the broader narrative shifting toward what 24/7 Wall St. termed a fracturing of the unified AI chip trade. NVDA finished essentially unchanged at +0.05%, INTC was modestly lower, and AMD bore the entire selling pressure on its own. The setup matters: AMD enters the print with consensus near $1.28 EPS on $9.88B revenue, against company guidance of approximately $9.8B and 55% non-GAAP gross margins. The question the print answers is not whether AMD beats — it is whether the sequential decline gets framed as seasonality or softness, and whether MI300/MI350 traction and TSM capacity allocation justify the multiple.

Underneath, the divergence ran the other direction in crypto. Bitcoin reclaimed $80,000 on a confluence of Senate stablecoin compromise news and renewed CLARITY Act momentum, with Senators Tillis and Alsobrooks reaching bipartisan agreement on stablecoin yield provisions. IBIT advanced +2.09%, ETHA +2.01%, COIN +6.14% into its Wednesday print, HOOD +3.92%, MARA +3.23%, HUT +1.43%. The same session that punished AI hardware rewarded the digital-asset complex — the cleanest read on rotation rather than risk-off.

New York Fed President Williams delivered a Star-Wars-themed address ("There Is No Try") at the Council on Foreign Relations, closing with "May the 4th be with you." The substance: monetary policy remains well positioned, the FOMC's April 29 hold at 3.50–3.75% reflects appropriate calibration, and the Middle East conflict represents the principal substantial risk in the outlook. Factory Orders for March printed +1.5% MoM versus +0.5% consensus — a meaningful upside surprise that did nothing to lift the tape. Total Vehicle Sales came in at 15.9M against 16.0M consensus.

IOWN Tactical: The session resolved the morning's open question by going the other way. Pre-market AI strength gave way to AI dispersion; convoy day produced no oil reaction; and crypto carried the digital-asset sleeve while the equity complex sorted itself out by name.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

COIN +6.14% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $202.99 on Bitcoin's reclaim of $80,000 and bipartisan Senate compromise on the Digital Asset Market Clarity Act stablecoin yield provisions per Investorideas. Q1 earnings due May 7.

HOOD +3.92% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $76.55 alongside the broader crypto-equity bid. Direct beneficiary of the same regulatory clarity narrative driving COIN.

VST +3.59% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $160.85 as AI-power demand thesis held against the broader cyclical pullback. Independent power producers continue to benefit from data-center load growth.

FTNT +3.44% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $89.26 on continued positioning into the cybersecurity complex following last week's sector reassessment.

MARA +3.23% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $11.83 as Bitcoin's move through $80,000 lifted miner equities across the board.

IBIT +2.09% DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Closed $45.40 as Bitcoin reclaimed $80K on stablecoin regulatory progress and renewed institutional flows.

ETHA +2.01% DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Closed $17.77 in tandem with the broader digital-asset complex.

VLO +1.93% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $251.63 as refining-margin support remained intact even with crude futures pricing convoy normalization optionality.

HRMY +2.39% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $32.59 on continued specialty-pharma momentum.

LMT +1.06% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $518.19 as defense exposure carried forward sensitivity to the duration-extending Iran standoff.

DECLINERS

AMD –5.39% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $341.11 ahead of Tuesday-after-close earnings. HSBC downgrade Monday morning combined with what 24/7 Wall St. termed the fracturing of the unified AI chip trade — NVDA basically flat, INTC modestly lower, AMD carrying the selling pressure alone. Consensus: $1.28 EPS on $9.88B revenue.

QCOM –4.88% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $168.38 extending the post-earnings weakness from April 29. Q3 guidance below consensus and competitive intensity in datacenter remain the principal overhangs; Stifel raised PT to $320 even as Seeking Alpha flagged stretched valuation.

TOL –3.43% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $135.05 on broader homebuilder weakness. Mortgage-rate sensitivity continues to weigh on the cyclical complex; Q2 results due May 19 after close.

CHD –3.26% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $92.89 on profit-taking after RBC's "impressive" Q1 commentary failed to extend the post-earnings bid.

CRDO –2.34% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $180.06. Pre-market indicated +5.96% on the AI-data-center connector thesis, but the bid did not survive the open as the broader AI-edge complex sold off.

CL –2.17% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $85.37 on broad consumer-staples pressure. Q1 commentary on emerging-markets exposure remains supportive of the longer thesis.

ABT –2.15% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $87.54 on broader healthcare weakness.

SYF –2.01% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $74.24 as the credit-tightening read-through from the Senior Loan Officer Survey weighed on financials-adjacent names.

ORI –2.00% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $38.48 on insurance-sector pressure.

AEM –1.98% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $179.93 as gold sold off –2.48% to $4,529.30 alongside the broader risk repricing.

HOLDINGS NEWS

AMD reports Tuesday after the close. Consensus per TradingKey and TipRanks: $1.28–$1.29 EPS (+33% YoY) on $9.88B revenue (+33% YoY). Watch for whether management frames the sequential decline as seasonality versus softness, MI300/MI350 traction commentary, TSM capacity allocation, and hyperscaler order trajectory. Q4 2025 Data Center hit a record $5.4B (+39% YoY); the export-control overhang on MI308 to China remains in place at approximately $100M.

QCOM extending post-earnings reassessment. The April 29 Q2 print delivered a beat but was undermined by Q3 guidance pointing to mid- to high-single-digit sequential revenue decline and an approximate 17% EPS drop at the midpoint, driven by anticipated QCT Handsets weakness. Stifel raised PT to $320; Cantor also raised. Apple license risk and DRAM supply constraints remain the structural concerns, with the automotive segment ($1.1B Q1 revenue, +15% YoY, guiding 35%+ Q2 growth) the principal forward narrative.

COIN reports Wednesday after the close. Subscription & services guidance ($710–$790M) and OCC charter language are the watch items. Today's move on the Senate stablecoin compromise sets up the print into a friendlier regulatory backdrop than the Q4 release saw.

CHD posted "impressive" Q1 organic growth per RBC commentary, with volume driving the print. Today's –3.26% close reflects profit-taking on the post-earnings move rather than any change in the underlying read.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT ONE

–0.60%

vs. DVY –0.68% | SPY –0.38%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

+0.03%

vs. IUSG –0.16%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +12.49% vs DVY +8.82% / SPY +5.30%
Growth +5.52% vs IUSG +6.15%